

Alex Chen

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EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer, Stripe

Jan 2021 – Present

Payments Infrastructure Team

- Designed and implemented a distributed rate-limiting service handling 2.4M requests/sec, reducing payment processing failures by 34%
- Optimized critical-path database queries using B-tree index restructuring, cutting P99 latency from 180ms to 45ms across 12 microservices
- Led migration of monolithic payment routing engine to event-driven architecture serving 50M+ daily transactions with 99.99% uptime
- Mentored 4 junior engineers through design doc reviews and pair programming, resulting in 2 promotions within 12 months

Software Engineer, Dropbox

Jun 2018 – Dec 2020

Storage Infrastructure

- Built content-addressable storage layer that deduplicated 40% of stored data, saving \$2.8M annually in cloud storage costs
- Implemented consistent hashing for data distribution across 500+ nodes, improving load balancing by 60%
- Developed automated chaos testing framework that identified 23 critical failure modes before production deployment
- Contributed to open-source Rust SDK used by 3,000+ developers, authoring 15 merged PRs

Software Engineer Intern, Google

May 2017 – Aug 2017

Search Quality Team

- Developed query understanding model using TensorFlow that improved search relevance by 2.1% (measured via NDCG@10)
- Processed 500TB of search logs using MapReduce pipelines to generate training data for ranking models

EDUCATION

M.S. Computer Science – Stanford University

2018

Specialization: Systems and Networking

GPA: 3.9/4.0

B.S. Computer Science – UC Berkeley

2016

Dean's List, ACM ICPC Regional Finalist

GPA: 3.8/4.0

PROJECTS

Distributed Key-Value Store – Built Raft-consensus KV store in Go supporting linearizable reads, 100K ops/sec on 5-node cluster. 800+ GitHub stars.

Real-time Code Search Engine – Trigram-based code indexing over 10M+ files with sub-100ms query response.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: C++, Go, Python, Java, Rust, SQL **Systems:** Distributed systems, gRPC, Protocol Buffers, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform

Data: BigQuery, Spanner, Redis, PostgreSQL, Apache Kafka, MapReduce **ML:** TensorFlow, PyTorch, scikit-learn